

Rep. Tom Emmer on Brian Kilmeade Show

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BRIAN KILMEADE:

Majority Whip, Tom Emmer, joins us now. Congressman, great to have you.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Good to be with you, Brian.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

So what do you say of day one so far? What do you think so far of this first time ever Republican convention?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, I tell you what, I don't know that people have been doing this for years. I don't think many people knew what to expect, Brian, for a mid-year convention, as they're calling it. But I'll tell you, it shows the genius of President Trump yet again. You've got a media, present company excluded, you've got a media that's not going to report anything that's favorable to Republicans. So guess what? Donald Trump had an idea that we're all going to come together, we're going to show each other the energy that actually exists out there, the energy that they're trying to convince you every day with their left-sided articles and reports that doesn't exist. I saw it again in a very well-known publication that they say is supposed to lean to the right this morning, something about not filling up the stadium. I don't know where they were, but I was there last night. It was packed, Brian, and it was a great message by the president. The energy's palpable.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

Yeah, I mean, he definitely had a bounce and a step. He promised everyone \$5,000, basically a dividend for a successful economy. Here's a little of it. Cut one.

DONALD TRUMP:

Because we've done so well and because our country is making so much money that only I can make this promise to you. And here is my promise. If the Republicans win the House of Representatives and the United States Senate, both of them, because of our economic, tremendous economic success, like in history, we've never had anything like what's happening. But because of our tremendous strength and success economically, I will issue a dividend to every adult citizen in the United States of America for \$5,000.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

All right. So how do you do that?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, I think more importantly, think about the president that we have. Donald Trump is like no other, Brian, as you know. He always is thinking out of the box. More importantly, contrary to what some people read that as, you know, is populist politics doing whatever. This is Donald Trump. He talked about this long before last night, didn't put a number on it. But he's been talking about letting the American people share in the success of America. While Democrats talk about taxing you more and taking more of your money, Donald Trump talks about, you know what? We are so successful, I'm going to make sure every adult American gets a piece of that success. And guess what? He doesn't say Republican or Democrat. He says every adult American. The details, I think the details will now come. Bernie Marino, I think, said he's going to be drafting a bill in the Senate. I will have somebody doing the same thing in the House. And as the whip's office, Brian, you know, we stand ready and willing to move something as soon as it gets to the floor.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

Right. Are you guys going to be looking at the College Sports Act? Because it looks like the Senate might be voting on it and putting in your lap.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, well, I'm sure that they're going to do it, but they might want to take a look at the Save America Act. They might want to take a look at the National Defense Reauthorization Act. They might want to take a look at the Farm Bill. They might want to take a look at some 600 pieces of legislation that we already have over in the Senate that they haven't acted on, Brian. It would be great if the NIL issue could be dealt with. But if that's what they're doing right now, and I know this is the biggest thing if you're SEC, if you're Big Ten, everything else, I know it's a big deal because apparently pros are now going back to college. Why should we be surprised? It's going to need to be addressed, Brian. But right now there are a whole bunch of things that need to be addressed. So especially with the midterms right on the horizon, the Save America Act, that is a priority of the American people.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

But I mean, big and big, big, small, smaller bills do come to you. Do you guys plan on taking it up if it comes to you?

REP. TOM EMMER:

What our speaker has said is that no votes are expected in the House after next week, Brian. And unless the Senate does something that's necessary, in which case, then it's up to the speaker. My understanding is he's put everybody on 48 hours notice. So that's neither a yes nor a no. But our speaker has definitely left open the possibility that if the Senate finally starts doing something, that we'll be there to respond.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

All right. So we'll see how that goes, because the House has pretty much got everyone going to their own districts and and see how it goes. Do you believe that that are you concerned at all about the advances in A.I.? I know the data centers are a hot button, but now we're finding out about these models going so quick, it's scaring a lot of the developers. One of them joined Brett yesterday, resigned from Anthropic because of what he sees as an out of control potential. Cut 29.

JACOB COXON:

I was working on building A.I. systems to make them smarter. And recently I've come to the realization that many people expect the A.I. systems in the next few years to be potentially capable of essentially taking over the world. So it's basically a gamble that's happening on the part of these companies where there's a strong chance that these A.I. could take over.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

And he goes on. And we've had some other people say similar things. I just had Tristan Harris, who was on the stage with Bill Gates and Bill Gates agrees there are some of these A.I. agents that seem to be getting their mission and going beyond it. What have you been read into? Where do you stand?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, without naming the company, I've met with a company that's actually already has a platform in place to deal with A.I. and potential issues that go beyond the go beyond the parameters that are set for A.I. Brian, this gets way too complicated. And I'm not the high tech expert, but I'll tell you this. Human beings are going to have to be involved. So the idea that A.I. is going to take over the world and run things like some sci-fi movie, not accurate. Do we have to be thoughtful? Do we have to be deliberate? Yes, we do. But what we're getting right now is we're in a race with China. I tell people at home, and I'll say it to you, data centers, we already have them. We've had them for years. They use less water than a restaurant, than a golf course. You can put in local regulations in place that will force the data center to pay for its energy use and any additional that it causes. So you don't affect rate payers. But nobody's reporting this stuff, Brian. This is literally an attack that some have suggested is coming from our adversaries to try and slow us down. And if you don't have a data center, a data center is going to be a lot like, for me, the Transcontinental Railroad. Everybody wanted a depot in their town because it meant commerce. That is the 21st century when it comes to a data center. Those that have them are going to have that commerce. Those that don't risk not having it. So I'm a pro, and we need to make sure that the truth gets out, Brian, so that when we talk about being thoughtful and deliberate, we're not doing it with somebody's talking points that are not substantiated, like, oh, this is going to use all this water. Oh, this is going to cause your power bills to go way up. You got to get the truth out there, and then people have to have that very thoughtful and deliberate debate.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

So let's talk about the Minnesota Senate race. I've never remembered. Michelle Tafoya has got the Republican nomination in the latest poll that came out yesterday. She's within two points of Flanagan, the lieutenant governor. What's resonating with Michelle? How are they suddenly open to a Republican statewide?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, remember, Brian, that the poll that you just referred to is just a generic, you know, you put the two names up, Peggy Flanagan and Michelle Tafoya, and it comes back when you just say, do you like Tafoya, do you like Flanagan? Like you say, it comes back within the margin of error. It's actually a dead heat. What's interesting is when you do an informed ballot. So I assume that Michelle Tafoya and certainly supporters will start to inform the electorate when you inform them of who Peggy Flanagan is, that she's been the lieutenant governor and she's been Kim Wall's right-hand person when it comes to overseeing all the fraud that we've had in our state for the last seven and a half years, that she's actually worked with the Somali fraudsters, much like Ilhan Omar. Once you have the informed ballot, guess what, Brian? Michelle's winning by five points. It's not minus two. So this is a real race. Michelle Tafoya I think has surprised people. Not just another pretty face, not just a great communications person like Brian Kilmeade that I'm talking to. She's actually now gone on the campaign trail, and Brian, I've watched her. She just gets better and better, and a very solid candidate. You win with solid

candidates, you win with the right message. Minnesota is ripe for some surprises, Brian.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

And you would know. Absolutely would know. So we'll see, because their governor is a disgrace. He's leaving in disgrace, and a lieutenant governor to think that she knew nothing, and Peggy Flanagan knew nothing about all the fraud in these different communities throughout Minneapolis. You have to suspend disbelief, if I can quote Hillary Clinton.

REP. TOM EMMER:

So Michelle Tafoya is somebody that's not a radical conservative. She does fit with Minnesota, and she's not going to be intimidated in an open, unscripted situation. She spent the last 50 years like that.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

That's exactly right. You'd be surprised when you listen to her. I can tell the difference between people who are politicians and people who have core beliefs.

REP. TOM EMMER:

You can be both, but sometimes some politicians, you know, they run to the front of the crowd, Brian, and they say, follow me, right? Michelle, she's got core beliefs, and you can connect your message when you have those core beliefs, and she's doing that right now in Minnesota. Again, I think Minnesota could be a big surprise.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

Yeah, we'll see. I think New Hampshire is very much in play, Michigan is very much in play, Minnesota is very much in play, Texas, much to the surprise of Republicans, that's very much in play. So anyone who says they know what's going to happen in 50 days is just not telling the truth. Lastly, just before I let you go, Senator Fetterman hopped up and endorsed Dave McCormick and introduced him on tape at a Republican convention. How soon till he just becomes a Republican?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Before the next election, before his next election, I do believe that that's already a foregone conclusion. He's just surprised all of us, and I don't know, Brian, if you got to see a tape of his introduction of Senator McCormick, but it was great as an understatement. He's going, he might surprise us all in a couple of years, because he knows where the voters are, and that's where he's going. But it's clear that he knows his state, too. He knows the great history, and he knows its potential for the future. I think he's a Republican already, but we'll see when he makes that declaration.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

All right, Congressman Tom Emmer, thanks so much.

REP. TOM EMMER:

All right, Brian.

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For questions or corrections: mn06watch@gmail.com